SEED PITCH · ANDROID LAUNCH

The Comics Opening

Where $1.5M buys the most ground on Google Play — and why asking users for less is how we hold it.

Group 3

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Course

AN 306

Date

September 29th | October 1st

One budget, one app, one shot

We are founders of a startup with a **$1,500,000 budget** preparing to launch a new Android app. Before committing our limited resources, we want to use Google Play market data to identify an attractive category, determine whether a privacy-conscious permission strategy could differentiate our app, and choose a monetization approach based on successful competitors. Our audience is a seed-stage investor who has seen a hundred decks this quarter.

Q1 · CHOOSE THE MARKET

Which Google Play categories show high user demand but weaker incumbent quality?

Q2 · CHOOSE THE POSITION

Can requesting fewer permissions than competitors become a real advantage?

Q3 · CHOOSE THE MODEL

What monetization characteristics distinguish the most successful apps?

What we built the analysis on

2,312,832
apps after cleaning

2,288,800
matched to permission records

49
columns after engineering

Jun 2021
scrape date

Key columns used

- Category, Minimum Installs, Rating, Rating Count
- Free, Price, Ad Supported, In App Purchases
- permission_count, permission_types
- Last Updated, Released, Editors Choice

Features we engineered

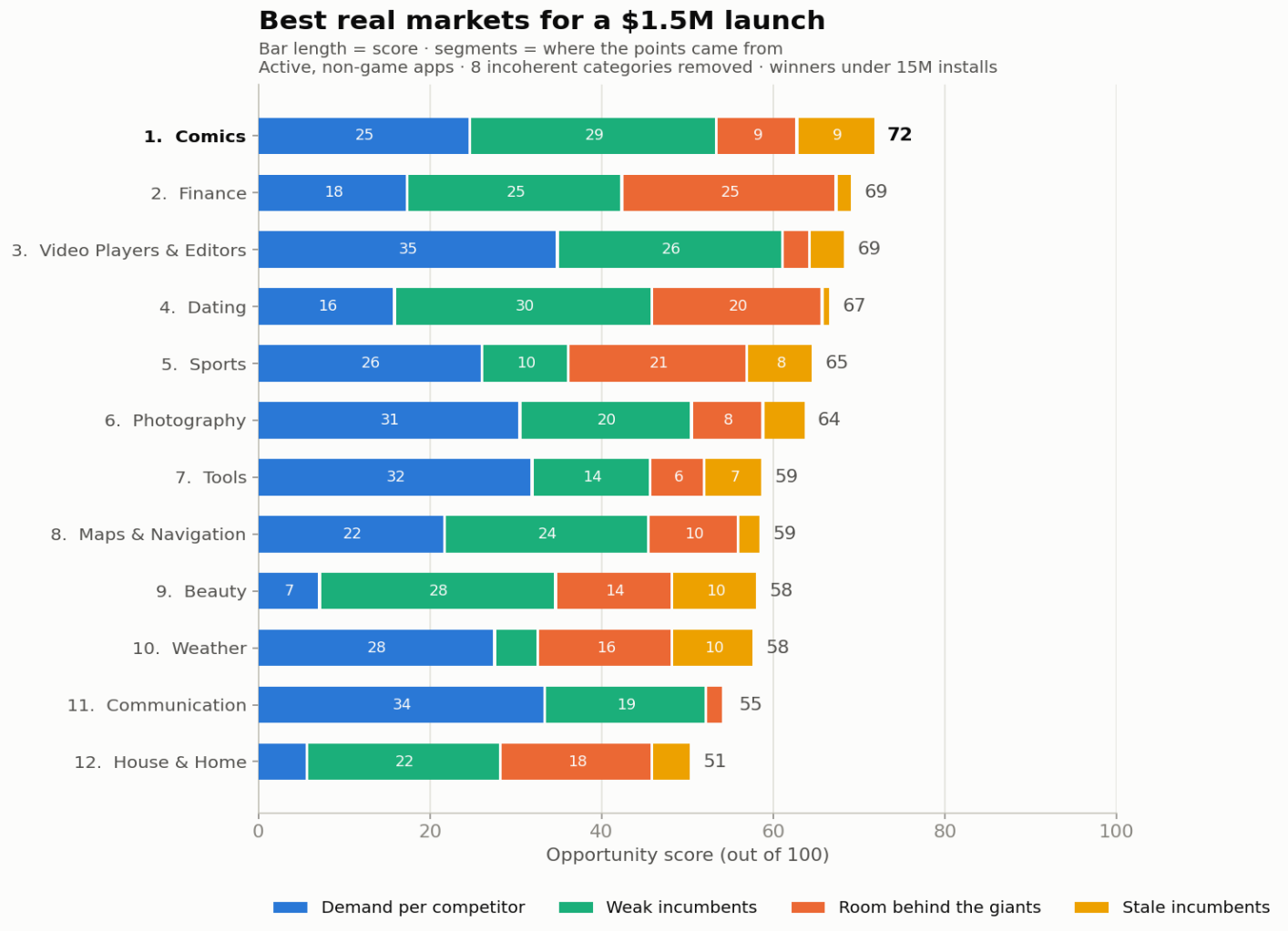
- sensitive_permission_count and privacy_tier
- 13 per-permission flags (perm_camera, perm_location…)
- monetization_model, is_successful, is_active
- days_since_update, install_tier, app_age_years

Cleaning decisions

- Left join on App Id, streaming the permissions JSON; 24,144 apps had no permission record and are flagged, not zeroed
- Unrated apps store a 0.0 rating; we set those to blank so they do not drag category averages down

Google Play Store dataset joined to app permissions · 112 rows dropped for missing name, category or install data

Q1: Which category gives a $1.5M team real demand and beatable incumbents?



Two earlier versions of this chart follow — see the next slide

KEY INSIGHT

- Comics scores **72/100** — driven by demand per competitor and weak incumbents, not by raw size.

BUSINESS IMPLICATION

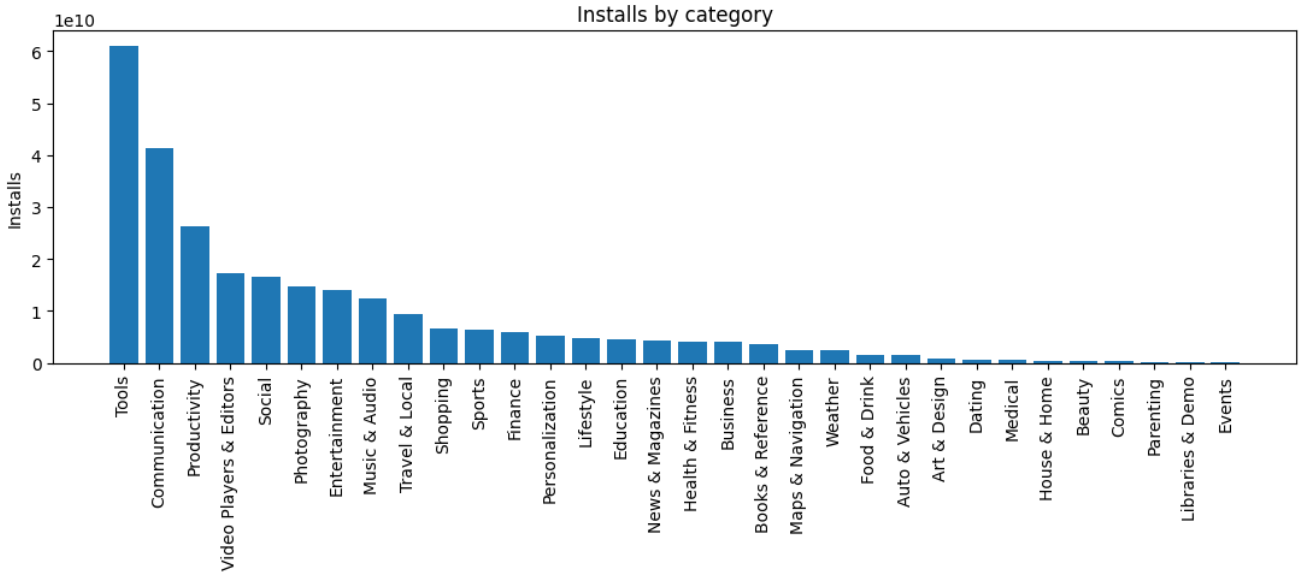
Launch in Comics. The demand exists, and no incumbent has locked it up.

METHOD CHOICES

Games and inactive apps dropped · incoherent "junk drawer" categories removed by a name-vocabulary test · categories above 15M median winner installs screened out as beyond our reach.

How we got there: two earlier versions of the same chart

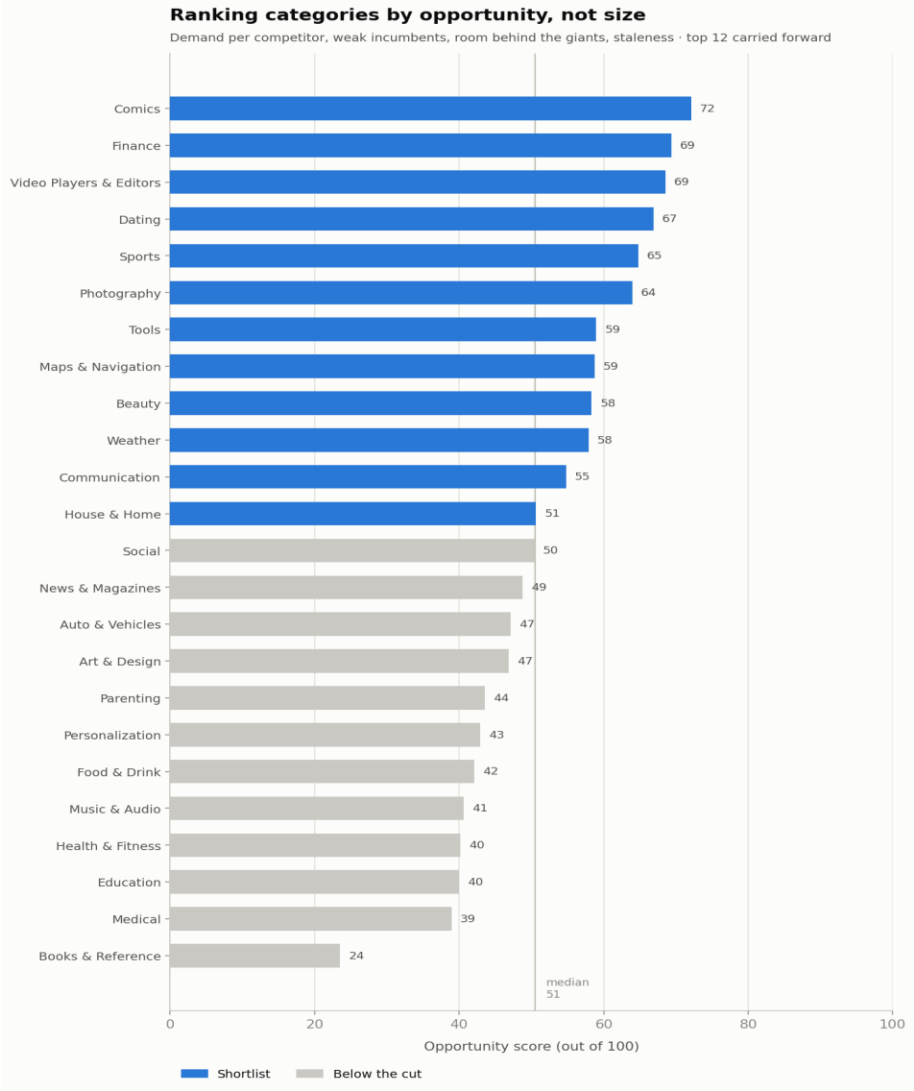
VERSION 1 · RANKED BY INSTALLS



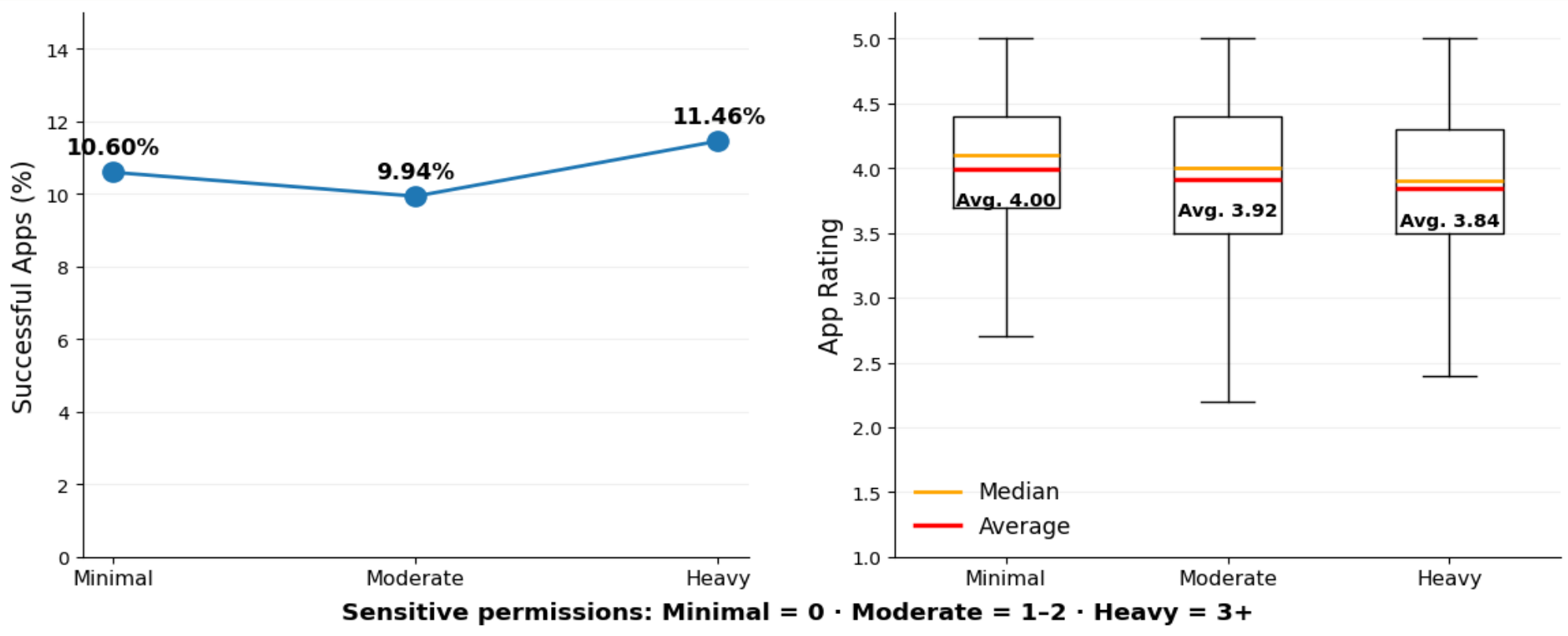
VERSION 1 - Answers the wrong question. Biggest is not best — this points at **Tools**, one of the most crowded category in the store.

VERSION 2 - Right question, readable axis, shortlist split out. But it shows **which** categories won without showing **why** — so no one can check our reasoning.

VERSION 2 · RANKED BY OPPORTUNITY



Q2: Can asking for fewer permissions be our edge in Comics?

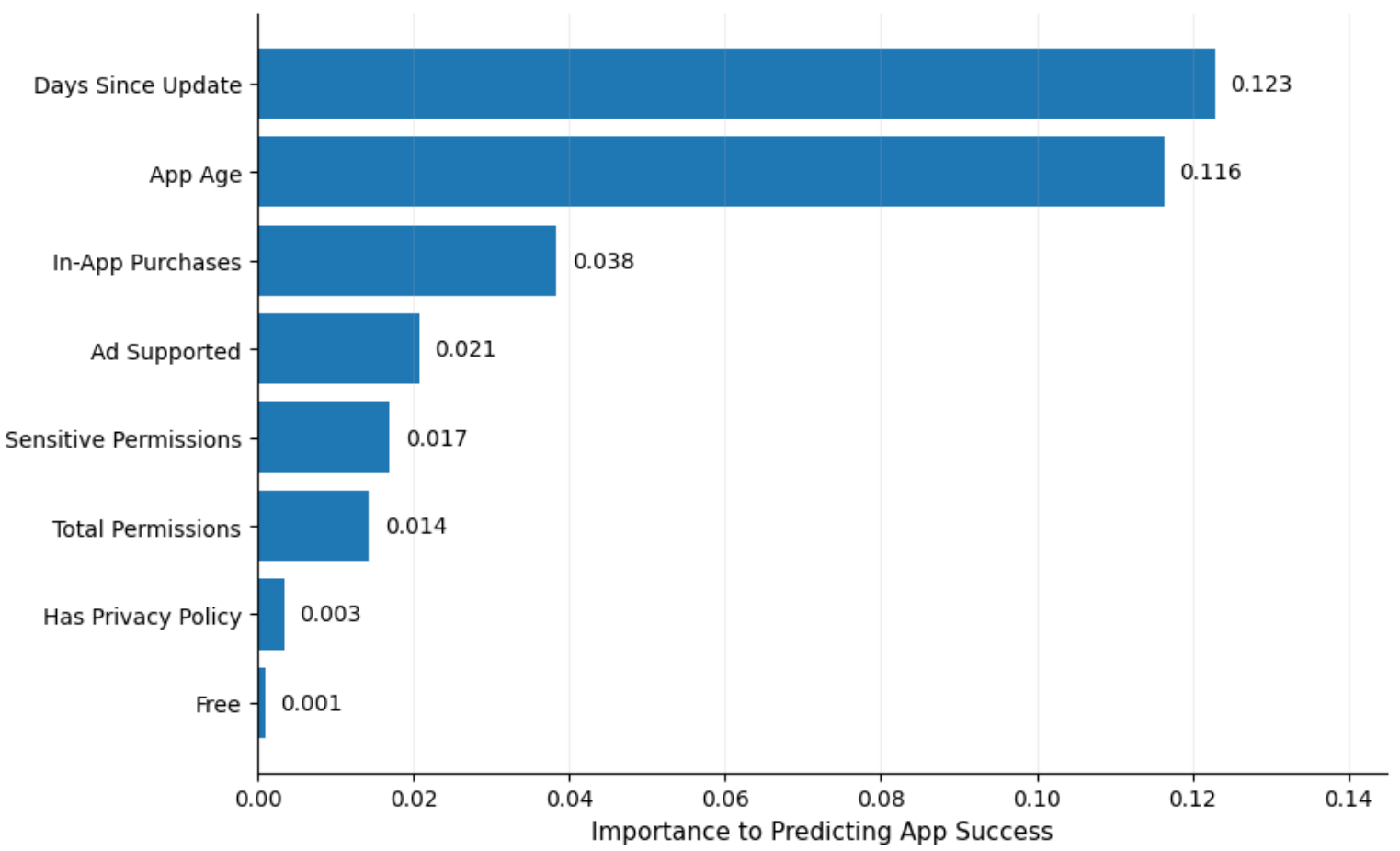


- Success rates barely move: Minimal **10.60%**, Moderate **9.94%**, Heavy **11.46%**.

- Ratings do move: **4.00 → 3.92 → 3.84** average as permissions rise. Minimal differs significantly from both; Moderate vs Heavy does not.

Apps with no permission record were excluded from this analysis, not treated as requesting zero

So what actually predicts a successful Comics app?



KEY INSIGHT

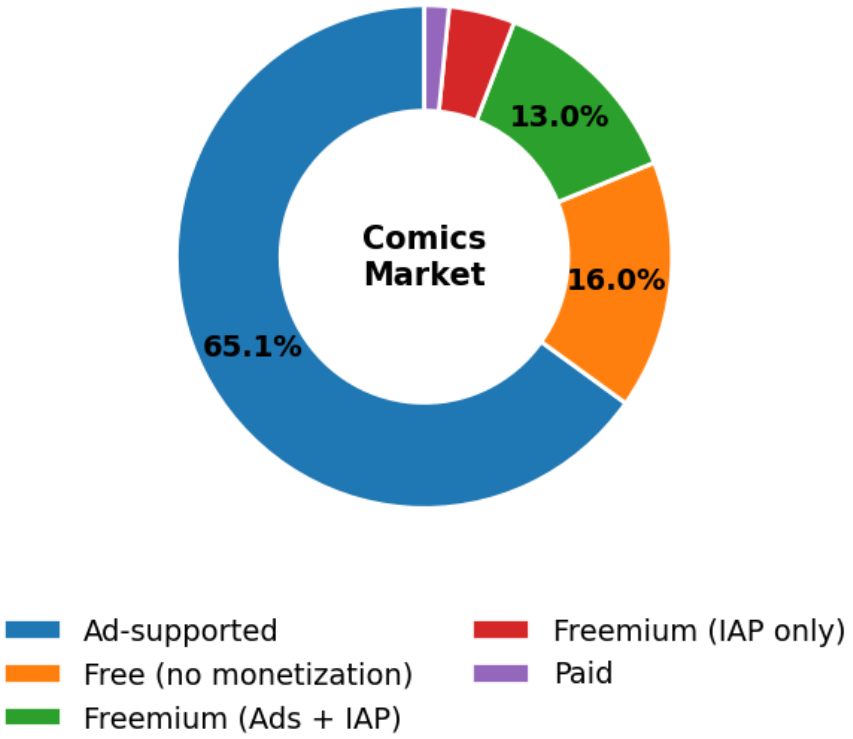
Days since update	**0.123**
App age	0.116
In-app purchases	0.038
Ad supported	0.021
Sensitive permissions	0.017
Total permissions	0.014

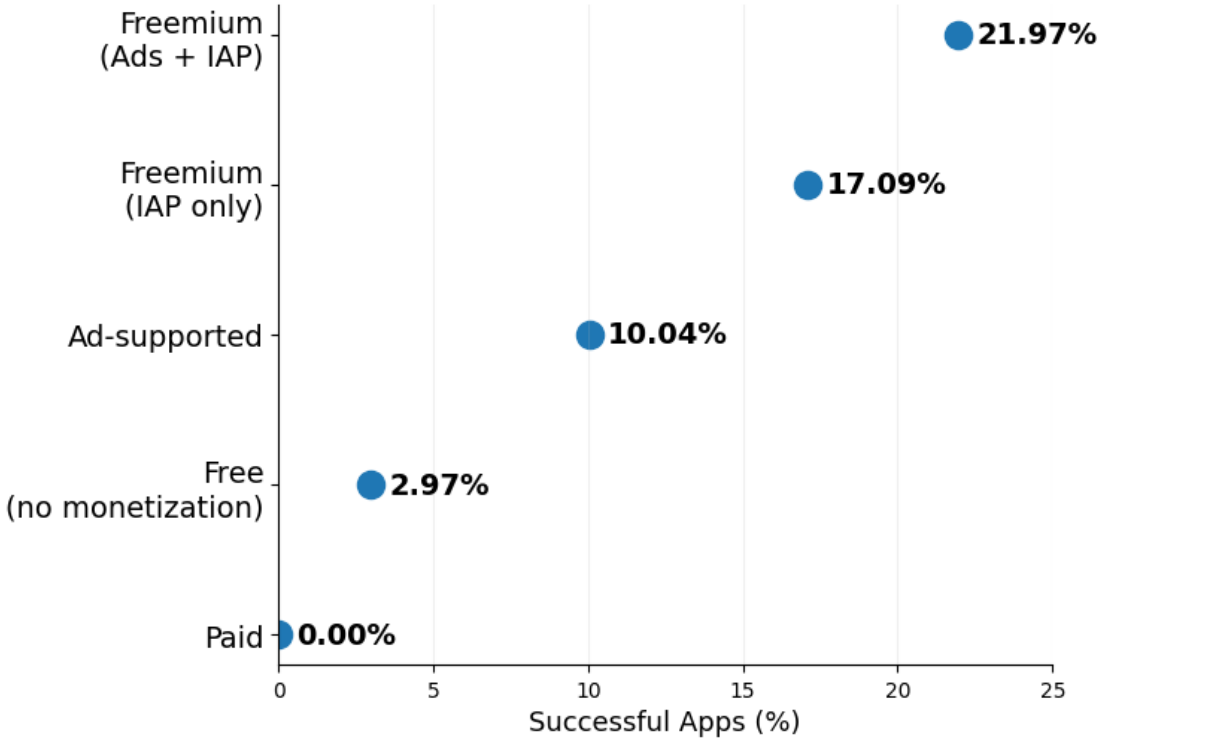
BUSINESS IMPLICATION

Prioritize sustained product maintenance. Update recency was far more predictive of success than permission-related features.

Higher importance = the model relied more on that feature to distinguish successful apps. Success = 100K+ installs and 4.0+ rating.

Q3: How Should We Monetize Our Comics App?





Median minimum installs: Ads + IAP = 50K • Ad-supported = 5K

- Ads alone dominate the market at **65.1%** of apps, but have a **10.04%** observed success rate.

- Ads + IAP is just **13.0%** of apps yet **26.9%** of successful apps, with the highest observed success rate at **21.97%** and **10×** the median minimum installs of ads alone.

Median installs: Ads + IAP 50,000 vs ads alone 5,000 · ratings ~4.0 for both, so the gap is adoption, not satisfaction · association, not causation

What we are asking you to fund

Q1 **Comics** — real demand per competitor, weak and neglected incumbents, and small enough that $1.5M is a credible entry.

Q2 **Privacy is positioning, not a growth engine.** Minimal-permission apps rate 4.00 vs 3.84, while success rates remain similar.

FI **Update recency and app age were much more predictive than permission variables** — 0.123 and 0.116 vs. 0.017 for sensitive permissions.

Q3 **Freemium (Ads + IAP)** — 13% of the market, 27% of successful apps, 10× the median minimum installs of ads alone.

WHAT THIS DATA CANNOT TELL YOU

- Scraped **June 2021**. Google's Data Safety rules and permission model have changed since.
- No revenue, retention or acquisition cost anywhere in the dataset — installs are a floor, not a P&L.
- **24,144 apps** carry no permission record and are excluded from the permission analysis.
- The privacy tier is a **teaching model** we defined, not a Google classification.
- Feature importance shows model usefulness, **not causation**.

Launch a **Comics** app with the $1.5M budget: free to download, monetized through **ads plus in-app purchases**, with restrained sensitive permissions as our trust position — with resources reserved for **sustained product maintenance.**